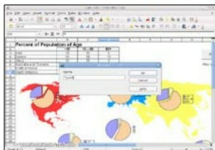


Technology News



OOo 3.1 now more than a match for MS Office

It's been less than a year since Sun Microsystems' OpenOffice.org hit its major 3.0 release, but the next version of the open source, cross-platform productivity suite is already available, complete with a slew of feature enhancements and performance



tweaks. The first thing you'll notice about the new OpenOffice 3.1 is that it just looks better—the program menus, letters and images it displays are sharper and clearer. This notable enhancement is thanks to the improved rendering of on-screen graphics through anti-aliasing, an advance that applies to the entire suite, but that should prove particularly pleasing to users of the product's presentation component, Impress.

A few improvements that OOo has done on the graphics front are anti-aliased drawings, solid dragging (now you can see the transparent image while dragging, and not just an outline) and also translucent selections in Writer.

Feature wise, OpenOffice.org 3.1 matches up fairly well with Microsoft's Office. In addition, the OpenOffice.org team has done a lot of work to make its suite compatible with MS Office's traditional binary and newer OOXML file formats. With the latest option to 'Reply to Notes', improved support for bi-directional scripts and the introduction of grammar checking, Writer has evolved into one of the best and most advanced open source word processors in the market.

Other interesting features that you will surely look forward to are an introduction of Macros and syntax highlighting in Base, 'Formula hot hints' in Calc and also a very notable performance boost to every OpenOffice.org application. Do download the office suite and let us know if you'd like to review it for us!

Samsung unveils Android smartphone

Samsung Electronics has launched the I7500—its first Android-powered mobile phone. The handset features a 3.2-inch (8.1 cm) Active Matrix OLED (AMOLED) touchscreen and 7.2Mbps HSDPA and Wi-Fi connectivity, giving users access to Google Mobile services and full Web browsing at blazing speeds. It offers users access to the full suite of Google services, including Google Search, Google Maps, Gmail, YouTube, Google Calendar and Google Talk. The integrated GPS receiver enables the use of Google Maps' features, such as My Location, Google Latitude, Street View, local search and detailed route description. Besides these, hundreds of other applications are available in the Android Market.

The Samsung I7500 comes with the latest multimedia features. Along with supporting a 5-megapixel camera and various multimedia codec formats, the I7500 also provides a long enough battery life (1500mAh) and a memory capacity of up to 40 GB (internal memory: 8GB, external memory, that's upgradeable up to 32GB) to enjoy all the applications and multimedia content. The phone also boasts of a slim and compact design, being just 11.9mm thin. It also includes a 3.5mm headphone socket.

The Samsung I7500 will be available in major European countries from June 2009. The company has not revealed pricing for the device.



Xen 3.4 promises reliability & availability

Xen.org has released a new version of Xen hypervisor. Xen 3.4 hypervisor offers significant enhancements in the following areas:

- Xen 3.4 contains the initial XCI code release providing a base client hypervisor for the community to extend and improve.
- The new version delivers a collection of features designed to avoid and detect system failures, provide maximum uptime by isolating system faults, and provide system failure notices to administrators to properly service the hardware/software.
- Xen 3.4 improves the power saving features with a host of new algorithms to better manage the processor, including schedulers and timers optimised for peak power savings.

Xen 3.4 is currently available via free download for developers at the Xen.org website: www.xen.org/download.

Qt open for community contributions

Nokia has announced that the Qt source code repositories are open to the public and that Qt developers now can help guide and shape the future development of Qt by contributing code, translations, examples, etc, to Qt and Qt-related projects. In order to help manage the contributions, Qt Software has launched a Web-based source code management system based on the Git and Gitorious open source projects, which is available at qt.gitorious.org.